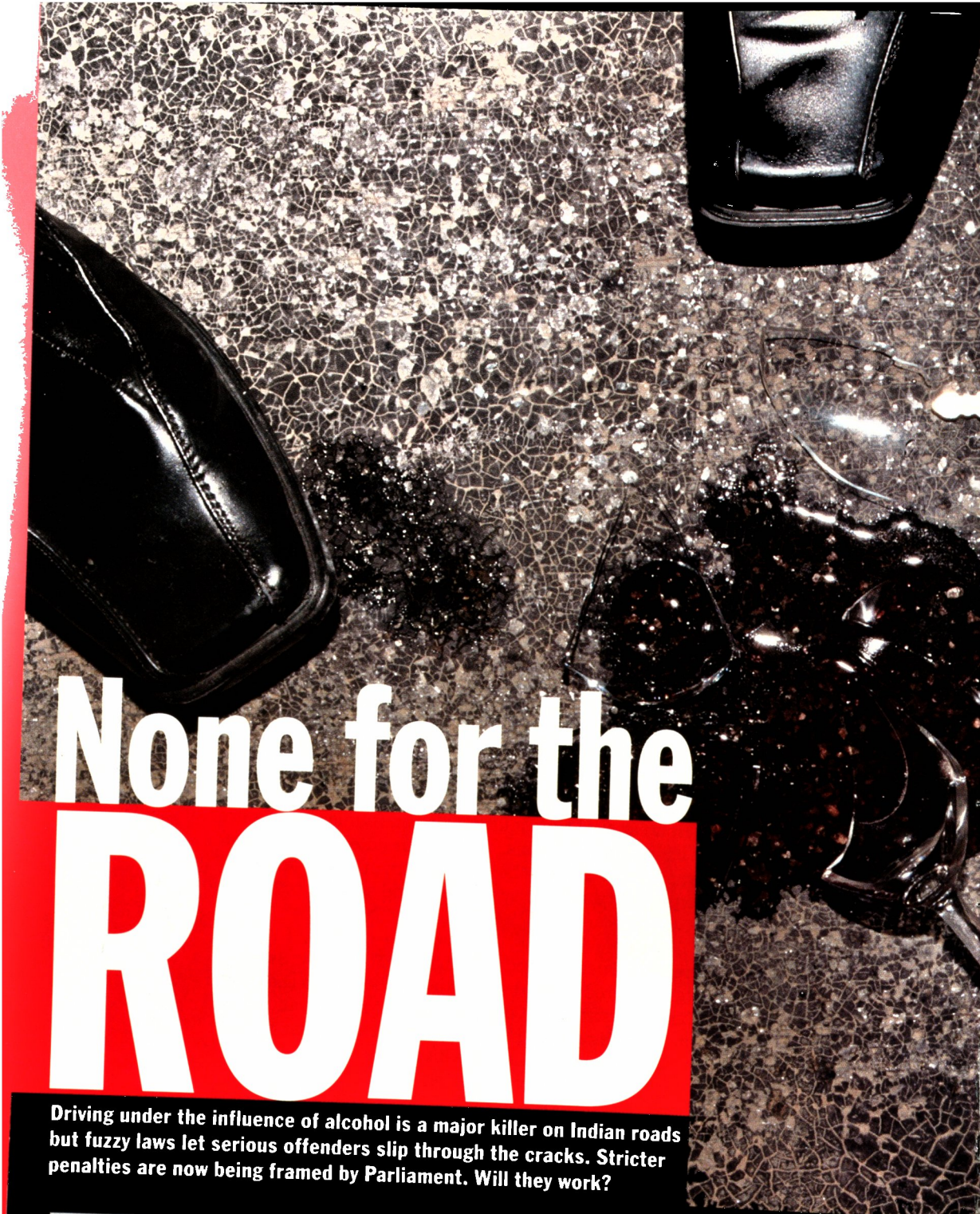




None for the ROAD

Driving under the influence of alcohol is a major killer on Indian roads but fuzzy laws let serious offenders slip through the cracks. Stricter penalties are now being framed by Parliament. Will they work?

GIVING LAWS TEETH

NOW: Under Section 185 of the Motor Vehicles Act, drunken driving is not a serious offence.

NEW: Harsher laws will make it a statutory offence, with tougher punishments.

NOW: Offenders are let off lightly. Serious cases are interpreted as 'rash and negligent' acts.

NEW: To be treated as pre-meditated crime and even culpable homicide not amounting to murder.

NOW: A paltry fine of up to Rs 2,000 or a prison term of up to six months or both.

NEW: Hefty fines, cancellation of driving licence and long-term imprisonment will be introduced.